NEW MASONS EVENING · CARD 3 OF 3

Words you will hear

Lodge	The basic unit: Freemasons who meet together, with a name and a number. Elects a Master and officers each year.
Province	The Lodges of a county area under a Provincial Grand Master. Above the Province is Grand Lodge.
UGLE	The United Grand Lodge of England, Freemasons' Hall, London: the governing body for English Freemasonry.
Summons	The notice of a meeting: date, time, dress, business, and who is doing what. Read it.
Festive Board	The meal after the meeting. Toasts, Masonic Fire, speeches; where friendships are made.
Masonic Fire	The applause that follows a toast. Your mentor will show you; nobody expects you to know it.
Lodge of Instruction	The rehearsal, usually informal, run by the Preceptor. Where you learn what you saw.
Installation	The yearly meeting at which the new Master is installed and appoints his officers.
Initiation, Passing, Raising	The three ceremonies that make you an Entered Apprentice, a Fellow Craft and a Master Mason.
Apron	White for an Entered Apprentice, then light blue, then dark blue for Provincial or Grand rank. Hence "light blue".
Regalia, jewels	Apron, collar for officers, gloves. Jewels are the medals worn on the breast.
Visiting	Attending another Lodge's meeting as a guest. Encouraged from the start.
Risings	The three points near the end of a meeting when the Master rises to ask for communications and apologies.
Royal Arch, Chapter	The completion of Pure Antient Masonry. A Chapter is to the Royal Arch what a Lodge is to the Craft.
Proposer, Seconder	The two members who put your name forward.
White Table, Ladies Night	A dinner to which partners are invited; the Master's formal dinner each year.

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Letters you will see

WM, IPM	Worshipful Master; Immediate Past Master, who has just left the Chair.
SW, JW	Senior and Junior Warden: with the Master, the three principal officers.
SD, JD, IG	Senior Deacon, Junior Deacon, Inner Guard: the floor officers.
DC, ADC	Director of Ceremonies and his Assistant. Follow the DC.
Tyler	The officer outside the door; the first person you met on your Initiation night.
Bro, W Bro, VW Bro, RW Bro	Brother; Worshipful Brother (has been Master); Very and Right Worshipful for senior Grand rank.
EA, FC, MM	Entered Apprentice, Fellow Craft, Master Mason.
PM	Past Master; in Hertfordshire mentoring documents also the Personal Mentor.
LM	Lodge Mentor: co-ordinates mentoring and makes sure every new member has a Personal Mentor.
ProvGM, DepProvGM, APGM	Provincial Grand Master, his Deputy, and the Assistant Provincial Grand Masters.
ProvGMen, APGMen	Provincial Grand Mentor and the Assistant Provincial Grand Mentors.
VO	Visiting Officer: visits your Lodge on the Provincial Grand Master's behalf. A friend, not an inspector.
LoI, CoI	Lodge of Instruction; Chapter of Instruction.
PGL, GL	Provincial Grand Lodge; Grand Lodge. PProvSGW, PAGDC and the like are Past Provincial or Grand ranks.
FHLBC, DAWG	Fleet House Light Blues Club; the Daily Advancement WhatsApp Group.
Solomon, Hermes	UGLE's learning platform; UGLE's membership administration system.

Nobody minds being asked what their letters mean. Ask.